Design Milestones

Yerba Mate Tea Machine

Discover 01

Keyword: Mate ritual, time-consuming, athletes

Prompt :

"What is yerba mate and why is it popular among athletes?"

AI Response Summary:

AI explained that yerba mate is a traditional South American beverage known for providing natural energy and improving focus, which makes it popular among professional athletes.

Reflection:

I realized that yerba mate is strongly associated with performance, endurance, and energy.

Design Decision:

The product will target professional athletes and users with busy lifestyles.

Accepted

The association between yerba mate and athletic performance

Rejected

Designing a general tea machine

Transformed

Traditional beverage → performance-oriented drink experience

Design Milestones

Yerba Mate Tea Machine

Research 02

Keywords: ritual, preparation process, traditional culture

Prompt :

"How is yerba mate traditionally prepared and how long does it take?"

AI Response Summary:

AI described the traditional mate preparation process as a ritualistic and time-consuming practice involving specific tools and steps.

Reflection:

The traditional preparation process may be too slow for modern fast-paced lifestyles.

Design Decision:

The machine should enable fast and convenient mate preparation.

Accepted

Removing the cultural reference

Rejected

The cultural significance of the traditional ritual

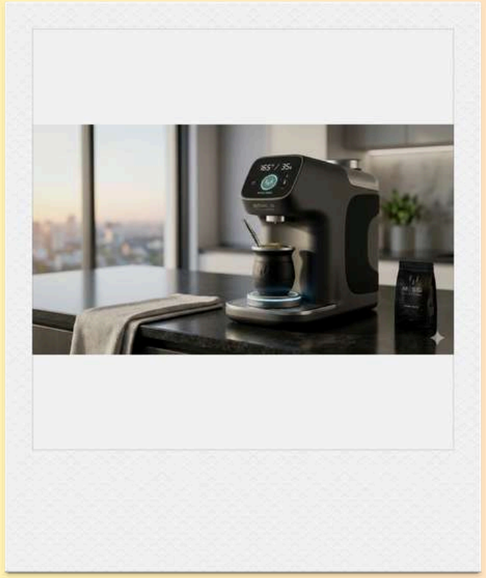
Transformed

Traditional ritual → simplified modern preparation

Design Milestones

Yerba Mate Tea Machine

Define 03



Keywords: modernization, accessibility, daily consumption

Prompt :

"How can we transform this ritualistic drink preparation into a faster consumption experience?"

AI Response Summary:

AI suggested reinterpreting the ritual by integrating its key elements into an automated system.

Reflection:

Mechanizing regional tea production with simple steps.

Design Decision:

Project concept:
"Reinterpreting Traditional Mate Culture for Modern Use."

Accepted

Removing the cultural reference

Rejected

The cultural significance of the traditional ritual

Transformed

Traditional ritual → simplified modern preparation

Design Milestones

Yerba Mate Tea Machine

Ideation 04

Keywords: interface, automation, usability

Prompt :

"What kind of system could a yerba mate machine use?"

AI Response Summary:

AI suggested several automated preparation systems and user interaction ideas.

Reflection:

No interface is needed; it should be simple and intuitive for quick use, I can use light signals, and the buttons should be easy to understand.

Design Decision:

Machine features:
Single outlet system for dispensing brewed yerba mate, Automated brewing mechanism, Simple button interface, LED indicator for readiness and maintenance

Accepted

A simplified brewing system that delivers ready-to-drink mate

Rejected

Separate outlets for mate leaves and hot water

Transformed

Traditional manual brewing → automated brewed mate dispensing system

Design Milestones

Yerba Mate Tea Machine

Visualization 05

Keywords: interface, automation, usability

Prompt :

"How can I create effective prompts to visualize the yerba mate machine?"

AI Response Summary:

AI helped generate prompts for producing realistic renders and product visualizations.

Reflection:

AI visualization tools helped quickly explore and communicate the design concept.

Design Decision:

The product will have a minimal and contemporary industrial design language.

Accepted

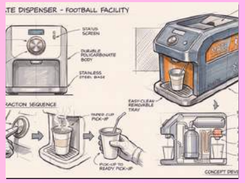
Using AI tools for rapid visualization

Rejected

Overly complex product forms

Transformed

Concept idea → visualized product design

Final Reflection

AI supported the design process by accelerating research, expanding ideation, and enabling rapid visualization of concepts. However, the final direction of the project and key design decisions were guided by my own design judgment and interpretation of the insights.